- It sets additional request headers that are not
  a Accept
  b Accept-Language
  c Content-Language
- The `XMLHttpRequest` contains upload events (section 4.5 shows an example using upload events)

The CORS spec collectively refers to these HTTP methods as *simple methods*, and the HTTP headers as *simple headers*. If these rules seem like a bit of a hodgepodge, it's because they are. There isn't any rhyme or reason as to why those rules are defined that way. It's a result of how the web has evolved over the past 20 years. But how these rules were defined isn't as important as identifying and responding to preflight requests. The next section modifies the sample app to respond to the preflight for the `DELETE` request.

4.3 Identifying a preflight request

In the context of the CORS lifecycle diagram, the preflight request is the first request sent from the browser to the server, as shown in figure 4.8. If a preflight request is just another HTTP request, how do you distinguish it from actual requests? The first thing you need to do is figure out what a preflight request looks like.

There are three characteristics of a preflight request, as shown in figure 4.9 it uses the HTTP `OPTIONS` method ❶, it has an Origin request header ❷, and it has an Access-Control-Request-Method header ❸.

Figure 4.9 shows the preflight request from the sample with each of these three characteristics highlighted. All three characteristics must exist on the request for it to be a preflight request. If any one of these pieces is missing, the request isn't a preflight. Let's dig deeper into what each of these pieces is.

4.3.1 Origin header

In chapter 3 you learned that every CORS request must have an Origin header. The preflight is no different. Without the Origin header, the request isn't a CORS request, and therefore it can't be a preflight request.

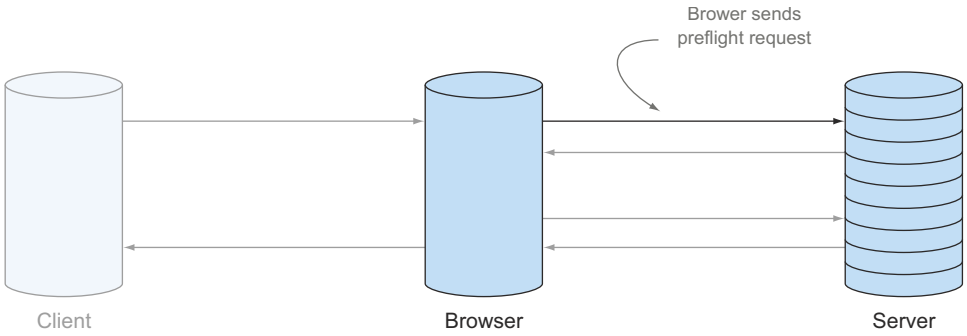


Figure 4.8 Preflight request